> keep their savings in commercial banks? To survive, the banks had to offer fantastic rates to attract depositors and invest in highly speculative ventures. Many did not make it and the banking system nearly collapsed.

Nigeria's demonetization had severe long-term consequences for the economy and particularly the banking sector. The results continued to be felt almost 10 years later.

A report in the *African Business* dated October 1993 stated, 'In November 1992, the Central Bank of Nigeria declared 46 banks as insolvent. By 1 September 1993, literally all the commercial banks in Nigeria were unable to meet their obligations to customers. Depositors were in most cases not allowed to withdraw amounts in excess of Naira 1,000, irrespective of their credit balances.'

As a result of his failed economic policies, Buhari was ousted in a coup the following year. However, he remained active in Nigerian politics and was re-elected as President in May 2015.

Burma/Myanmar:[16] Demonetizations of 1964, 1985 and 1987

In the early twentieth century, Burma was the second wealthiest country in South East Asia, after the Philippines. It controlled a wealth of natural resources, especially teakwood and petroleum. It was also one of the largest exporters of rice in the world.

Until 1943, the official currency of Burma was the Indian rupee, when it was replaced by the Burmese kyat. After Independence in 1948, Prime Minister U Nu embarked on a policy of nationalization. By the 1950s, rice exports had fallen by 66 per cent and mineral exports by 96 per cent. General Ne Win seized power through a military coup in 1962, and embarked on an economic scheme called the 'Burmese way to Socialism.'

Bertil Lintner's article in *the Washington Post* is succinct:

> The Burmese army seized not only political but also economic power. What the generals branded 'the Burmese Way to Socialism' meant that most private property was confiscated and handed over to military-run state corporations. The old mercantile elite, largely of Indian and Chinese origin, left the country, as did many of